

Hearing heartbeats

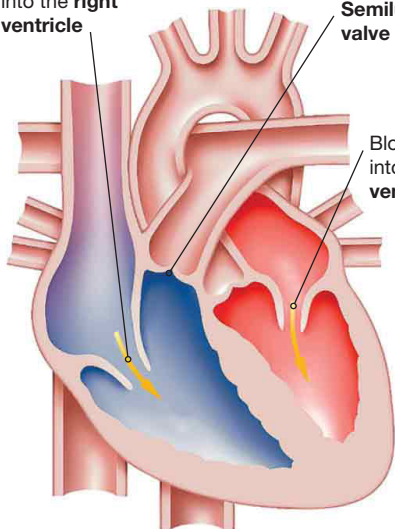
A doctor uses a stethoscope to listen to a person's heart and check if the heart valves are working properly. When the valves between the atria and the ventricles close, they make a loud “lub” sound, and when the semilunar valves slam shut, they make a shorter, sharper “dup” sound.



Blood flows into the **right ventricle**

Semilunar valve closed

Blood flows into the **left ventricle**



The **two atria contract** at the same time, pushing blood through open valves into the ventricles. The semilunar valves remain closed to stop blood from flowing backward.

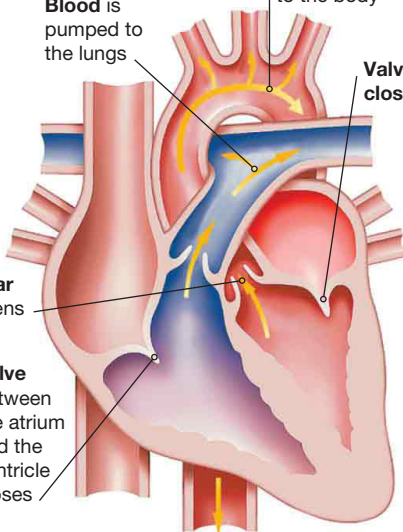
Blood is pumped to the lungs

Blood is pumped to the body

Valve closes

Semilunar valve opens

Valve between the atrium and the ventricle closes



The **ventricles contract**, forcing blood out of the heart through the open semilunar valves. Valves between the atria and ventricles close to prevent backflow.